



printer, mouse, whatever it might be, and Windows will display a list of related links. Integrated search is a big step forward, but keep in mind that it only works fully in category view. Type Printer there, for example, and you'll get links to add or remove printers, share a printer on the network, manage colours, update drivers and more.

Type Printer in Classic View instead and you'll get a single link to the Printers applet only, not nearly so helpful.

Tip 5

Now you've got used to changing the Control Panel's layout, it's time to start exploring some of the more advanced ways to use it. Press Start, then immediately type control. Press Enter and the Control Panel will

TYPE THIS...	...TO DO THIS
Appwiz.cpl	Uninstall or change a program
Desk.cpl	Change display settings
Firewall.cpl	Configure Windows firewall
Inetcpl.cpl	Change internet options
Intl.cpl	Change regional and language options
Main.cpl	Configure mouse settings
Mmsys.cpl	Change sound settings
Ncpa.cpl	Configure network connections
Powercfg.cpl	Change power saving options
Timedate.cpl	Change date and time
Wscui.cpl	Open Windows Security Center

launch. Press Start again, type `ncpa.cpl`, press Enter and you'll see the Network Connections window open. You can do the same for many of the items in the Control Panel (the table on the right shows a selection of these shortcuts). This is a great way to launch your most frequently used Control Panel settings without having to move away from the keyboard to pick up your mouse.

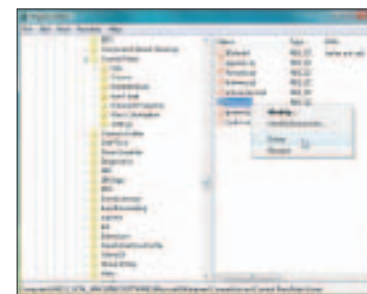
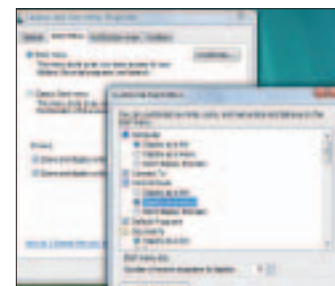
Tip 6

To access all the Control Panel functions directly from the Start menu, hover your mouse over the Start button, right-click and select Properties from the menu. You'll then see a dialogue box with a button labelled 'Customize...' at the top right. Click this and scroll down until you see the Control Panel entry, then click the 'Display as a menu' button. This will make the Control Panel appear as a fly-out menu on the Start panel rather than opening up in a separate window. You can also do the same

for the advanced System Administrative Tools. Just scroll down the Customize list to find the entry, then click the 'Display on the All Programs and the Start menu' button.

Tip 7

Windows Vista has the same Display Settings and Network Connections applets as XP, but they're harder to find. Use System Restore to back up your setting before making any changes to the Registry (type System Restore into the Start menu Search box). Then click Start, type REGEDIT and press Enter on your keyboard to launch the Registry Editor. Now browse to `HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Control Panel\don't load`. Right-click `desk.cpl` in the right-hand pane and click Delete > Yes to restore Display Settings, and similarly delete `ncpa.cpl` to restore the Network Connections applet. Reopen the Control Panel and your favourites will have returned.



Tip 8

The Autoplay applet is a welcome addition, delivering a sensible way to decide what your PC should do when you insert an audio CD, DVD or game. Click Control Panel, select Hardware and Sound if you're using the category view, then click Autoplay to launch it. At its simplest you can use this to set up the media player that will be launched to play a particular file type. So you

